

CourtCraft Basketball Training Plans

Practice plans exported from the local app data, including U16.

Independent elite player development resource. Not official NBA content.

Age Groups

U8 - Ages 7-8

Recommended duration: 30-60 min

Focus: fun, coordination, basic movement, basic ball control, layup foundations

Load note: 120 minutes is a camp format only. Use breaks, games, coordination blocks, and low-pressure teaching.

U11 - Ages 9-11

Recommended duration: 45-75 min

Focus: ball control, footwork, passing, finishing, form shooting, basic 1v1

Load note: 120 minutes should be treated as camp/intensive work with healthy rest and game-based learning.

U14 - Ages 12-14

Recommended duration: 60-90 min

Focus: decision-making, finishing through constraints, shooting off movement, team spacing, defensive habits

Load note: 120 minutes is allowed only with planned breaks, teaching segments, and controlled high-intensity volume.

U16 - Ages 15-16

Recommended duration: 75-105 min

Focus: advanced footwork, advantage reads, shooting off movement, finishing through pressure, defensive rotations, transition habits

Load note: 120 minutes is an intensive format for U16 unless the group is already conditioned for elite workload.

High School / Elite - Grades 9-12 / ages 15-18

Recommended duration: 90-120 min

Focus: advanced reads, pressure decisions, shooting volume, advantage creation, defensive rotations, conditioning

Preset Practice Plans

U8 recommended plan (U8, 60 min)

Build joy, coordination, ball comfort, simple passing, and a controlled finish without long hard-work stretches.

Load note: Keep intensity playful. Use short lines, frequent encouragement, and water whenever attention drops.

Timeline:

8 min - Warm-up: Partner Mirror Movement

Cue: Raise body temperature, build coordination, and preview the day's cue.

12 min - Skill block 1: Red Light Green Light Dribble

Cue: Teach the primary skill with clean repetitions before speed.

12 min - Skill block 2: Form Shooting Close Finish; Mikan Intro Without Speed

Cue: Add pressure, decision timing, or a second connected skill.

12 min - Competitive game / SSG: Treasure Chest Dribbling Game; Numbers Layup Game

Cue: Transfer the skill into scoring, stops, and real choices.

10 min - Team concept block: Pass And Follow

Cue: Connect individual habits to spacing, coverage, or transition rules.

6 min - Cooldown / review: Small-Sided Games King Of The Court

Cue: Lower intensity, review cues, and finish with controlled makes or reflection.

U8 2-hour camp/intensive format (U8, 120 min)

Use a camp rhythm built around games, coordination, short ball-control bursts, and rest rather than 120 minutes of hard drill work.

Warning: 120 minutes is a camp format for U8. Use breaks, low-intensity games, coordination stations, and teaching pauses.

Load note: Keep most work low to medium intensity. Add bathroom and snack breaks outside the listed water block if needed.

Timeline:

14 min - Warm-up: Partner Mirror Movement

Cue: Raise body temperature, build coordination, and preview the day's cue.

22 min - Skill block 1: Red Light Green Light Dribble

Cue: Teach the primary skill with clean repetitions before speed.

5 min - Water / rest: Water, reset, teaching check, and role rotation.

Cue: Hydrate, reset attention, and keep work:rest healthy.

22 min - Skill block 2: Form Shooting Close Finish; Mikan Intro Without Speed

Cue: Add pressure, decision timing, or a second connected skill.

25 min - Competitive game / SSG: Treasure Chest Dribbling Game; Numbers Layup Game

Cue: Transfer the skill into scoring, stops, and real choices.

22 min - Team concept block: Pass And Follow

Cue: Connect individual habits to spacing, coverage, or transition rules.

10 min - Cooldown / review: Small-Sided Games King Of The Court

Cue: Lower intensity, review cues, and finish with controlled makes or reflection.

U11 recommended plan (U11, 75 min)

Blend ball control, footwork, passing, finishing, shooting form, and simple 1v1 reads.

Load note: Use stations and short competitions so repetitions stay high without turning every block into conditioning.

Timeline:

9 min - Warm-up: Jump Stop Balance Race

Cue: Raise body temperature, build coordination, and preview the day's cue.

16 min - Skill block 1: Zig-Zag Change of Direction; Partner Passing Windows

Cue: Teach the primary skill with clean repetitions before speed.

15 min - Skill block 2: Catch-Square-Shoot; Weak-Hand Layup Ladder

Cue: Add pressure, decision timing, or a second connected skill.

16 min - Competitive game / SSG: 2v1 Advantage Read

Cue: Transfer the skill into scoring, stops, and real choices.

13 min - Team concept block: Shell Defense Intro 3v3

Cue: Connect individual habits to spacing, coverage, or transition rules.

6 min - Cooldown / review: Rebound Hit-Find-Get

Cue: Lower intensity, review cues, and finish with controlled makes or reflection.

U11 2-hour camp/intensive format (U11, 120 min)

Extend practice through stations, game-based constraints, and teaching blocks while protecting attention and mechanics.

Warning: 120 minutes is a camp/intensive format for U11. Include planned breaks and simple competitive games.

Load note: Avoid stacking high-intensity blocks. Use water, role rotation, and teaching demos after competitive segments.

Timeline:

14 min - Warm-up: Jump Stop Balance Race

Cue: Raise body temperature, build coordination, and preview the day's cue.

22 min - Skill block 1: Zig-Zag Change of Direction; Partner Passing Windows

Cue: Teach the primary skill with clean repetitions before speed.

5 min - Water / rest: Water, reset, teaching check, and role rotation.

Cue: Hydrate, reset attention, and keep work:rest healthy.

22 min - Skill block 2: Catch-Square-Shoot; Weak-Hand Layup Ladder

Cue: Add pressure, decision timing, or a second connected skill.

25 min - Competitive game / SSG: 2v1 Advantage Read

Cue: Transfer the skill into scoring, stops, and real choices.

22 min - Team concept block: Shell Defense Intro 3v3

Cue: Connect individual habits to spacing, coverage, or transition rules.

10 min - Cooldown / review: Rebound Hit-Find-Get

Cue: Lower intensity, review cues, and finish with controlled makes or reflection.

U14 recommended plan (U14, 90 min)

Develop decision-making, finishing through constraints, shooting movement, defensive habits, and team spacing.

Load note: Keep competitive pressure high enough to transfer, but separate the hardest blocks with water and teaching.

Timeline:

10 min - Warm-up: Change Pace Attack Cones

Cue: Raise body temperature, build coordination, and preview the day's cue.

18 min - Skill block 1: Drift Pass Drive And Kick; Slot Cut Read

Cue: Teach the primary skill with clean repetitions before speed.

4 min - Water / rest: Water, reset, teaching check, and role rotation.

Cue: Hydrate, reset attention, and keep work:rest healthy.

18 min - Skill block 2: Finishing Through Contact Pads; Closeout Read 1v1

Cue: Add pressure, decision timing, or a second connected skill.

18 min - Competitive game / SSG: 3v2 Continuous Advantage

Cue: Transfer the skill into scoring, stops, and real choices.

16 min - Team concept block: Shell Defense 4v4 No Paint Touch

Cue: Connect individual habits to spacing, coverage, or transition rules.

6 min - Cooldown / review: 5-Spot Shooting Standards

Cue: Lower intensity, review cues, and finish with controlled makes or reflection.

U14 2-hour camp/intensive format (U14, 120 min)

Use the longer block to teach constraints, small-sided decisions, and team concepts without overloading contact or sprint volume.

Warning: 120 minutes is allowed for U14 only with breaks, teaching pauses, and controlled high-intensity volume.

Load note: Separate high-intensity contact and transition work. Add extra recovery if mechanics or communication degrade.

Timeline:

- 14 min - Warm-up: Change Pace Attack Cones
 - Cue: Raise body temperature, build coordination, and preview the day's cue.
- 22 min - Skill block 1: Drift Pass Drive And Kick; Slot Cut Read
 - Cue: Teach the primary skill with clean repetitions before speed.
- 5 min - Water / rest: Water, reset, teaching check, and role rotation.
 - Cue: Hydrate, reset attention, and keep work:rest healthy.
- 22 min - Skill block 2: Finishing Through Contact Pads; Closeout Read 1v1
 - Cue: Add pressure, decision timing, or a second connected skill.
- 25 min - Competitive game / SSG: 3v2 Continuous Advantage
 - Cue: Transfer the skill into scoring, stops, and real choices.
- 22 min - Team concept block: Shell Defense 4v4 No Paint Touch
 - Cue: Connect individual habits to spacing, coverage, or transition rules.
- 10 min - Cooldown / review: 5-Spot Shooting Standards
 - Cue: Lower intensity, review cues, and finish with controlled makes or reflection.

U16 recommended plan (U16, 90 min)

Bridge advanced youth development and elite structure with shooting movement, advantage reads, finishing pressure, and connected defense.

Load note: Keep quality high by separating contact, transition, and high-volume shooting with water and teaching resets.

Timeline:

- 10 min - Warm-up: Change Pace Attack Cones
 - Cue: Raise body temperature, build coordination, and preview the day's cue.
- 18 min - Skill block 1: NBA-Style Footwork Shooting Series; Drift Pass Drive And Kick
 - Cue: Teach the primary skill with clean repetitions before speed.
- 4 min - Water / rest: Water, reset, teaching check, and role rotation.
 - Cue: Hydrate, reset attention, and keep work:rest healthy.
- 18 min - Skill block 2: Finishing Through Contact Pads; X-Out Defensive Rotation
 - Cue: Add pressure, decision timing, or a second connected skill.
- 18 min - Competitive game / SSG: 4v4 Advantage Constraints
 - Cue: Transfer the skill into scoring, stops, and real choices.
- 16 min - Team concept block: Spain Action Walkthrough; Transition Fill The Lanes
 - Cue: Connect individual habits to spacing, coverage, or transition rules.
- 6 min - Cooldown / review: 5-Spot Shooting Standards
 - Cue: Lower intensity, review cues, and finish with controlled makes or reflection.

U16 2-hour intensive format (U16, 120 min)

Use the longer block for advanced reads, competitive constraints, and team concepts without stacking too much high-intensity load.

Warning: 120 minutes is intensive for U16 unless the group is prepared for elite workload. Include hydration, teaching pauses, and controlled contact.

Load note: Avoid more than two high-intensity blocks in sequence. Reduce contact or sprint volume if mechanics drop.

Timeline:

- 14 min - Warm-up: Change Pace Attack Cones
 - Cue: Raise body temperature, build coordination, and preview the day's cue.
- 22 min - Skill block 1: NBA-Style Footwork Shooting Series; Drift Pass Drive And Kick
 - Cue: Teach the primary skill with clean repetitions before speed.
- 5 min - Water / rest: Water, reset, teaching check, and role rotation.
 - Cue: Hydrate, reset attention, and keep work:rest healthy.

22 min - Skill block 2: Finishing Through Contact Pads; X-Out Defensive Rotation

Cue: Add pressure, decision timing, or a second connected skill.

25 min - Competitive game / SSG: 4v4 Advantage Constraints

Cue: Transfer the skill into scoring, stops, and real choices.

22 min - Team concept block: Spain Action Walkthrough; Transition Fill The Lanes

Cue: Connect individual habits to spacing, coverage, or transition rules.

10 min - Cooldown / review: 5-Spot Shooting Standards

Cue: Lower intensity, review cues, and finish with controlled makes or reflection.

High School / Elite 120-min advanced plan (High School / Elite, 120 min)

Train advanced reads, shooting volume, advantage creation, defensive rotations, and competitive late-clock execution.

Load note: This is normal elite duration, but high-speed and contact blocks still require rotation and hydration.

Timeline:

14 min - Warm-up: Two-Ball Pressure Handle

Cue: Raise body temperature, build coordination, and preview the day's cue.

22 min - Skill block 1: NBA-Style Footwork Shooting Series; Ball Screen Snake Read

Cue: Teach the primary skill with clean repetitions before speed.

5 min - Water / rest: Water, reset, teaching check, and role rotation.

Cue: Hydrate, reset attention, and keep work:rest healthy.

22 min - Skill block 2: Veer Finish And Euro Read; X-Out Defensive Rotation

Cue: Add pressure, decision timing, or a second connected skill.

25 min - Competitive game / SSG: Late Clock 1v1/2v2 Decision Game

Cue: Transfer the skill into scoring, stops, and real choices.

22 min - Team concept block: 4v4 Advantage Constraints; Transition Conversion Defense

Cue: Connect individual habits to spacing, coverage, or transition rules.

10 min - Cooldown / review: 5-Spot Shooting Standards

Cue: Lower intensity, review cues, and finish with controlled makes or reflection.

Drill Library Index

Use this index to quickly match a plan segment to drill detail pages in the app. Court diagrams remain in the app.

U8 drills (11)

- Red Light Green Light Dribble - 8 min, low, ball handling. Build stop-start control, eyes-up dribbling, and balance without rushing young players.
- Cone Island Ball Control - 8 min, low, ball handling. Teach young players to change direction around space while protecting the ball.
- Partner Mirror Movement - 6 min, low, movement. Develop balance, coordination, and defensive movement through a simple mirror game.
- Treasure Chest Dribbling Game - 10 min, medium, ball handling. Combine ball control, spatial awareness, and fun competition for young players.
- Jump Stop Balance Race - 7 min, low, movement. Teach controlled jump stops, pivot balance, and clean starts before players move fast.
- Form Shooting Close Finish - 8 min, low, shooting. Build close-range shooting touch with balanced feet and a soft release.
- Mikan Intro Without Speed - 8 min, low, finishing. Introduce right-left finishing footwork near the rim without turning it into a speed test.
- Pass And Follow - 8 min, low, passing. Teach pass accuracy, moving after a pass, and spacing in a simple pattern.
- Defensive Stance Freeze Tag - 8 min, medium, defense. Make defensive stance and change of direction playful while controlling workload.
- Numbers Layup Game - 10 min, medium, finishing. Connect listening, quick starts, and controlled layup finishes in a competitive game.
- Small-Sided Games King Of The Court - 12 min, medium, decision making. Use short competitive games to transfer skills into decisions while keeping players engaged.

U11 drills (11)

- Zig-Zag Change of Direction - 12 min, medium, ball handling. Train controlled changes of direction with eyes up and a useful push out of each move.
- Pound-Cross-Retreat Series - 10 min, medium, ball handling. Build a pressure handle sequence that combines power, separation, and re-attack.
- Partner Passing Windows - 10 min, low, passing. Improve passing accuracy through moving targets and simple defender windows.
- Catch-Square-Shoot - 12 min, medium, shooting. Teach players to arrive balanced on the catch and shoot with repeatable footwork.
- 1-2 Step Form Shooting - 10 min, low, shooting. Build shooting footwork by linking an inside-outside 1-2 step to a stable release.
- Weak-Hand Layup Ladder - 12 min, medium, finishing. Increase weak-hand confidence through progressive finishes from controlled starts.
- Closeout To Contain - 12 min, medium, defense. Teach defenders to close space under control and keep the ball in front.
- 2v1 Advantage Read - 12 min, medium, decision making. Teach the ball handler to score when the defender commits late and pass when help stops the ball.
- Shell Defense Intro 3v3 - 14 min, medium, team concepts. Introduce ball, gap, and help positioning with simple 3v3 spacing.
- Rebound Hit-Find-Get - 10 min, medium, rebounding. Teach the rebounding sequence of contact, location, and pursuit.
- Small-Sided Games King Of The Court - 12 min, medium, decision making. Use short competitive games to transfer skills into decisions while keeping players engaged.

U14 drills (24)

Zig-Zag Change of Direction - 12 min, medium, ball handling. Train controlled changes of direction with eyes up and a useful push out of each move.

Pound-Cross-Retreat Series - 10 min, medium, ball handling. Build a pressure handle sequence that combines power, separation, and re-attack.

Catch-Square-Shoot - 12 min, medium, shooting. Teach players to arrive balanced on the catch and shoot with repeatable footwork.

Weak-Hand Layup Ladder - 12 min, medium, finishing. Increase weak-hand confidence through progressive finishes from controlled starts.

Closeout To Contain - 12 min, medium, defense. Teach defenders to close space under control and keep the ball in front.

2v1 Advantage Read - 12 min, medium, decision making. Teach the ball handler to score when the defender commits late and pass when help stops the ball.

Rebound Hit-Find-Get - 10 min, medium, rebounding. Teach the rebounding sequence of contact, location, and pursuit.

Change Pace Attack Cones - 12 min, medium, ball handling. Train slow-to-fast rhythm so players create advantages without needing extra moves.

Finishing Through Contact Pads - 12 min, high, finishing. Develop strong, legal finishes through controlled contact without sacrificing footwork.

Drift Pass Drive And Kick - 12 min, medium, passing. Teach corner drift timing and drive-and-kick passing against help.

Slot Cut Read - 10 min, medium, decision making. Teach slot players to cut, hold, or replace based on defender position.

Closeout Read 1v1 - 12 min, high, decision making. Connect offensive catch decisions to defender speed, angle, and hand position.

Pick-And-Roll Pocket Read Intro - 14 min, medium, team concepts. Introduce the pocket pass read when the screen defender steps up to stop the ball.

3v2 Continuous Advantage - 14 min, high, decision making. Develop pace, spacing, and quick decisions in repeated transition advantages.

Shell Defense 4v4 No Paint Touch - 14 min, high, team concepts. Build connected help, stunt, closeout, and gap habits with a clear defensive constraint.

Spain Action Walkthrough - 14 min, low, team concepts. Introduce a pro-level ball screen action with a back screen on the roller and clear spacing.

Transition Fill The Lanes - 12 min, medium, team concepts. Teach players to sprint wide, organize early offense, and create simple transition spacing.

Relocation Shooting Off Drive - 14 min, medium, shooting. Train shooters to move with the driver and create clean kickout windows.

4v4 Advantage Constraints - 16 min, high, team concepts. Create game-speed decisions by giving offense a temporary advantage and defense a recovery goal.

X-Out Defensive Rotation - 14 min, high, defense. Teach two defenders to cover corner and wing after a drive-and-kick scramble.

Closeout To Boxout Chain - 12 min, medium, defense. Link the closeout, contest, contact, and rebound into one defensive habit chain.

5-Spot Shooting Standards - 15 min, medium, shooting. Create measurable shooting accountability from five core perimeter locations.

Two-Ball Pressure Handle - 12 min, medium, ball handling. Challenge hand independence and posture under ball-control pressure.

Small-Sided Games King Of The Court - 12 min, medium, decision making. Use short competitive games to transfer skills into decisions while keeping players engaged.

U16 drills (24)

Change Pace Attack Cones - 12 min, medium, ball handling. Train slow-to-fast rhythm so players create advantages without needing extra moves.

Finishing Through Contact Pads - 12 min, high, finishing. Develop strong, legal finishes through controlled contact without sacrificing footwork.

Drift Pass Drive And Kick - 12 min, medium, passing. Teach corner drift timing and drive-and-kick passing against help.

Slot Cut Read - 10 min, medium, decision making. Teach slot players to cut, hold, or replace based on defender position.

Closeout Read 1v1 - 12 min, high, decision making. Connect offensive catch decisions to defender speed, angle, and hand position.

Pick-And-Roll Pocket Read Intro - 14 min, medium, team concepts. Introduce the pocket pass read when the screen defender steps up to stop the ball.

3v2 Continuous Advantage - 14 min, high, decision making. Develop pace, spacing, and quick decisions in repeated transition advantages.

Shell Defense 4v4 No Paint Touch - 14 min, high, team concepts. Build connected help, stunt, closeout, and gap habits with a clear defensive constraint.

Spain Action Walkthrough - 14 min, low, team concepts. Introduce a pro-level ball screen action with a back screen on the roller and clear spacing.

Transition Fill The Lanes - 12 min, medium, team concepts. Teach players to sprint wide, organize early offense, and create simple transition spacing.

NBA-Style Footwork Shooting Series - 16 min, high, shooting. Train advanced trainer-standard footwork patterns: hop, 1-2, drift, and turn catches.

Relocation Shooting Off Drive - 14 min, medium, shooting. Train shooters to move with the driver and create clean kickout windows.

Veer Finish And Euro Read - 14 min, high, finishing. Train advanced finish selection when a defender rides the drive line or steps across the lane.

Ball Screen Snake Read - 16 min, high, decision making. Teach the ball handler to snake back across the screen defender and control the middle.

Reject Screen Attack - 14 min, high, decision making. Train the ball handler to reject a screen when the on-ball defender overplays the screen side.

Weak-Side Shake Decision - 14 min, medium, decision making. Teach the weak-side shooter to shake behind help when the low defender tags the roll.

4v4 Advantage Constraints - 16 min, high, team concepts. Create game-speed decisions by giving offense a temporary advantage and defense a recovery goal.

X-Out Defensive Rotation - 14 min, high, defense. Teach two defenders to cover corner and wing after a drive-and-kick scramble.

Transition Conversion Defense - 16 min, high, defense. Train players to convert from offense to defense, stop the ball, protect the rim, and match shooters.

Late Clock 1v1/2v2 Decision Game - 14 min, high, decision making. Train efficient shot creation and pass decisions under a short clock.

Closeout To Boxout Chain - 12 min, medium, defense. Link the closeout, contest, contact, and rebound into one defensive habit chain.

5-Spot Shooting Standards - 15 min, medium, shooting. Create measurable shooting accountability from five core perimeter locations.

Two-Ball Pressure Handle - 12 min, medium, ball handling. Challenge hand independence and posture under ball-control pressure.

Small-Sided Games King Of The Court - 12 min, medium, decision making. Use short competitive games to transfer skills into decisions while keeping players engaged.

High School / Elite drills (22)

Change Pace Attack Cones - 12 min, medium, ball handling. Train slow-to-fast rhythm so players create advantages without needing extra moves.

Finishing Through Contact Pads - 12 min, high, finishing. Develop strong, legal finishes through controlled contact without sacrificing footwork.

Drift Pass Drive And Kick - 12 min, medium, passing. Teach corner drift timing and drive-and-kick passing against help.

Closeout Read 1v1 - 12 min, high, decision making. Connect offensive catch decisions to defender speed, angle, and hand position.

Pick-And-Roll Pocket Read Intro - 14 min, medium, team concepts. Introduce the pocket pass read when the screen defender steps up to stop the ball.

3v2 Continuous Advantage - 14 min, high, decision making. Develop pace, spacing, and quick decisions in repeated transition advantages.

Shell Defense 4v4 No Paint Touch - 14 min, high, team concepts. Build connected help, stunt, closeout, and gap habits with a clear defensive constraint.

Spain Action Walkthrough - 14 min, low, team concepts. Introduce a pro-level ball screen action with a back screen on the roller and clear spacing.

NBA-Style Footwork Shooting Series - 16 min, high, shooting. Train advanced trainer-standard footwork patterns: hop, 1-2, drift, and turn catches.

Relocation Shooting Off Drive - 14 min, medium, shooting. Train shooters to move with the driver and create clean kickout windows.

Veer Finish And Euro Read - 14 min, high, finishing. Train advanced finish selection when a defender rides the drive line or steps across the lane.

Ball Screen Snake Read - 16 min, high, decision making. Teach the ball handler to snake back across the screen defender and control the middle.

Reject Screen Attack - 14 min, high, decision making. Train the ball handler to reject a screen when the on-ball defender overplays the screen side.

Weak-Side Shake Decision - 14 min, medium, decision making. Teach the weak-side shooter to shake behind help when the low defender tags the roll.

4v4 Advantage Constraints - 16 min, high, team concepts. Create game-speed decisions by giving offense a temporary advantage and defense a recovery goal.

X-Out Defensive Rotation - 14 min, high, defense. Teach two defenders to cover corner and wing after a drive-and-kick scramble.

Transition Conversion Defense - 16 min, high, defense. Train players to convert from offense to defense, stop the ball, protect the rim, and match shooters.

Late Clock 1v1/2v2 Decision Game - 14 min, high, decision making. Train efficient shot creation and pass decisions under a short clock.

Closeout To Boxout Chain - 12 min, medium, defense. Link the closeout, contest, contact, and rebound into one defensive habit chain.

5-Spot Shooting Standards - 15 min, medium, shooting. Create measurable shooting accountability from five core perimeter locations.

Two-Ball Pressure Handle - 12 min, medium, ball handling. Challenge hand independence and posture under ball-control pressure.

Small-Sided Games King Of The Court - 12 min, medium, decision making. Use short competitive games to transfer skills into decisions while keeping players engaged.